

TOP PREDATOR

Orcas are giant dolphins with jaws full of big, sharp teeth. They prey on anything they can catch and kill, including fish, penguins, seals, and even polar bears and other whales. They can rip big animals apart, but often swallow seals whole. Killer whales are found in oceans throughout the world, traveling in family groups called pods. Each pod contains about 20 members, which usually stay together for life and share the care of the young.

▼ ORCA

A male orca leaps from the water in an icy polar sea. Males have much taller dorsal fins than females.



PACK HUNTERS

Like all whales and dolphins, orcas are very intelligent, and often cooperate to hunt. Here, four orcas have joined forces to catch a crabeater seal resting on an ice floe. Three of them are creating a wave that will wash over the ice and sweep the seal into the water, where the fourth hunter is waiting to seize it.



WOW!

Each pod of orcas specializes in hunting a particular type of prey, and even has its own unique language of sounds and calls.

